Subscription, Rev-Share & Referral Plans — Final Review

BIRTHRIGHT FOUNDATION · SECURE BONDS > THRIVE · EXPORTED MAY 24, 2026 05:24 UTC

REVIEW DOCUMENT. These are the plans currently seeded in the database (pre-traction × 0.5 multiplier applied). Approve to commit to git → next deploy goes live. Reject any line to revise before commit.

1 · Facilitator subscriptions

PLAN	FEE	FOUNDATION IP[1] (FOUNDATION SHARE)	NON-IP[2] (FOUNDATION SHARE)	OFF-SITE[3]
Facilitator — Monthly	$49.50	50%	20%	7%
Facilitator — Annual	$449.50	42%	15%	5%
Facilitator — 2-Year	$749.50	35%	10%	3%

Rationale. [1] **Foundation IP rev-share** applies when the facilitator hosts a workshop using Birthright-curated curriculum, methodology, or branded materials. Foundation share decreases from 50% → 42% → 35% as commitment lengthens — rewarding longer subscriptions with better take-home for the facilitator. **35% is a hard floor** that can only be reduced via admin override + governance audit log (per v1.6.0).
[2] **Non-IP rev-share** applies when a facilitator hosts their own workshops with their own content using Birthright as the venue + marketing + checkout layer. Foundation share is much lower (20% → 15% → 10%) because we don't own the IP — we're competing with Teachable/Thinkific and must stay attractive.
[3] **Off-site rev-share** applies when a participant clicks through from a facilitator's Birthright profile to the facilitator's external site and buys there. Foundation captures 7% → 5% → 3% — fair recognition of attribution + traffic without overstepping on revenue we don't process.

Why subscription fees exist at all. The fee primarily buys the **right to teach Foundation IP workshops**. There is no facilitator-only material library (materials are activating, not conceptual, and are participant-purchased). Facilitators who only run non-IP workshops can evaluate whether the subscription's other benefits (integrated payouts, indemnification, marketing assets, virtual venue, cross-pollination) are worth the cost — competitive vs Teachable/Thinkific/Kajabi.

2 · Vendor subscriptions

PLAN	FEE	ON-SITE[1] (FOUNDATION SHARE)	OFF-SITE[2]
Vendor — Monthly	$24.50	22%	7%
Vendor — Annual	$209.50	17%	5%
Vendor — 2-Year	$374.50	12%	3%

Rationale. [1] **On-site rev-share** on every vendor product sold through Birthright's store. Foundation share decreases from 22% → 17% → 12% with commitment. Competitive vs Faire (15–25%) and Amazon Handmade (15%), and far below the take rate of a high-traffic marketplace — appropriate given Birthright is curated + pre-traction.
[2] **Off-site rev-share**: when a vendor lists their external store URL on their Birthright profile and a Birthright visitor clicks through and buys, foundation captures 7% → 5% → 3%. Reflects attribution + traffic delivered, nothing more.

Why vendor fees are lower than facilitator fees. Vendors don't access any Foundation IP — they're paying for distribution + checkout infrastructure + AI mockup generation + zero listing fees + workshop-bundle access for foundation events. The fee floors at $24.50/mo (pre-traction) so the barrier to entry is genuinely low for niche craftspeople aligned with the mission.

3 · Community / Affiliate plans

PLAN	FEE	THEIR REFERRAL SHARE[1]
Community — Starter (Free)	FREE	8%
Community — Plus (Monthly)	$9.50	10%
Community — Pro (Annual)	$49.50	12%
Community — 2-Year Pro	$74.50	14%

Rationale. [1] **This is the COMMUNITY PARTNER's share**, not the foundation's. When a community partner sends an inbound referral that converts on Birthright, the partner keeps 8% → 10% → 12% → 14% of the purchase value. Foundation keeps the remainder. **Higher commitment = higher partner share** — the inverse direction of facilitator/vendor because here we're paying THEM, and we want to keep good affiliates.

Volume bonuses stack on top of the base share for paid tiers: +2% after 25 conversions/yr · +2% more after 50 · +4% more after 100. Significantly outpaces Amazon Associates (1-10%) and is competitive with Impact.com (10-30%).

Why FREE Starter. Charging affiliates a subscription contradicts every industry norm (Amazon Associates, ShareASale, Impact.com, Substack — all free for affiliates). The Free tier removes the friction; paid tiers (Plus / Pro / 2-Year Pro) add specific benefits like custom UTM links, monthly digests, featured listing eligibility, locked rates.

4 · Research plans

PLAN	FEE	ON-SITE SHARE[1] (FOUNDATION)	OFF-SITE SHARE[2]
Research — Standard (Free)	FREE	5%	3%
Research — Citation Pro (Annual)	$49.50	5%	3%
Research — Citation Pro (2-Year)	$74.50	5%	3%

Rationale. [1] **On-site rev-share** applies only when a research item is monetized (paid white paper, premium download). Foundation keeps 5% across all tiers — flat by design because most research is non-commercial.
[2] **Off-site rev-share** applies when Birthright traffic clicks through and buys a researcher's paid item elsewhere. Foundation captures 3% — low because the value researchers bring is primarily reputational (eminence), not monetary.

Why FREE Standard tier. Academic platforms are mostly free (ResearchGate, SSRN); academics build careers on citation reach, not platform fees. Charging would suppress submissions and damage the foundation's credibility as a research host.

Eminence Sharing Agreement. All approved research partners sign an addendum to v1.6.0 indemnification capturing non-monetary value: co-citation, press-release co-rights, speaking-engagement first-right, endorsement clause, funding-introduction commission (2-3% of foundation-introduced grants), data co-ownership of anonymized workshop datasets. This is how the foundation participates in the eminence the researcher builds.

À-la-carte paid promotion exists separately as one-time Stripe charges: **Featured Research $99/mo · Highlighted Research $29/wk**. Promoted research displays clear "Sponsored" microcopy for transparency.

5 · Product types & material handling

TYPE	WHO CAN BUY	REV-SHARE
`merch`	Anyone	Foundation 100% or vendor split per their plan
`workshop_material`	ONLY paid registrants of that workshop	**Foundation 100%** (less Community referral if applicable)
`facilitator_material` NEW	ONLY active Facilitator partner profiles	Foundation 100%
`vendor_product`	Anyone	Vendor's plan applies

Rationale. Workshop materials are gated to **paid registrants of that workshop only**. This protects Foundation IP from leakage (facilitators cannot bulk-buy and take materials out of the ecosystem) and increases participant agency, which is core to material efficacy.

No facilitator commission on Foundation material purchases. Five reasons: (1) professional ethics codes (APA/ACA/NASW/ICF) prohibit dual-relationship financial benefits with clients; (2) facilitators are already fully compensated via subscription + workshop rev-share; (3) materials are bundled by the foundation, not curated by facilitators — nothing to compensate; (4) every $1 in commission is $1 not reinvested in better materials; (5) skipping commissions removes FTC #ad disclosure complications.

Required vs optional materials. Required materials (`is_required: true`) auto-add to the workshop ticket at registration. Optional materials are nudged by the foundation directly (checkout, confirmation email, dashboard, mid-workshop reminders) — the facilitator is never the salesperson.

6 · Participant referrals — store credit, not cash

TRIGGER	REWARD	FORM
Participant refers friend → friend completes a workshop	**15%** of friend's purchase	Store credit toward referrer's next purchase

Rationale. Store credit (not cash) avoids 1099 reporting, W-9 collection, payout-batch infrastructure, and FTC paid-endorsement complications. Credit applies to workshops, materials, OR merch — participant choice. Auto-applies at checkout (toggleable). Tracked via new `user_credits` ledger collection. Loops people back into the ecosystem rather than leaking cash out.

7 · Refund / clawback policy

CANCEL TIMING	TICKET REFUND	MATERIAL REFUND
> 72 hours before workshop	**Full**	**Full**
24–72 hours before	**Full**	None
< 24 hours before	None	None
Facilitator-initiated cancellation	**Full**	**Full**

Rationale. Mirrors industry standard for digital-product platforms. Stripe refunds trigger automatic referral-row clawback per the v1.11.0 Step 8 cascade — preserves data integrity in the payouts ledger.

8 · Cross-cutting principles (governance & mechanics)

A · BTI multiplier (traffic-adjusted pricing)

BTI RANGE	MULTIPLIER	PLAIN ENGLISH
0.0 – 0.2 (today)	**× 0.50**	Pre-traction discount — what is currently seeded
0.2 – 0.5	× 0.70	Early launch
0.5 – 1.0	× 0.85	Approaching parity
1.0 – 1.5	× 1.00	Standard market rate (the table values above × 2)
1.5 – 2.5	× 1.15	Premium — outperforming competitors
2.5+	× 1.30	Hard cap on surge

> **BTI applies to subscription FEES only.** Rev-share percentages stay BTI-stable because partners' per-transaction income should be predictable. Quarterly recalculation. Existing subscribers grandfathered at signup rate until renewal. Founding partners immune to increases; still benefit from decreases.
>
> Formula: `BTI = (90d_unique_visitors / 50,000) × (90d_conversion / 0.025)`. Published transparently at `/governance/revenue-sharing` (to be built in v1.11.0 Step 7).

B · Founding Partner program

> First 25 partners per type (100 total) get standard prices × 0.75 locked for 5 years from signup. Available only via admin invite during the 2-month outreach window. Immune to BTI surge increases (wins both ways: benefits from decreases too). Public "Founding Partner" badge.
>
> **What "standard" means here:** the BTI=1.0 rate (twice the currently-seeded pre-traction prices). So a Founding Facilitator Annual = $899 × 0.75 = $674/year, locked through 2031. As BTI rises and other partners see fees rise, founders stay at $674.

C · Admin overrides & rev-share exceptions

> The Foundation IP rev-share floor of 35% (foundation share) cannot drop below 35% via the normal commitment ladder. Admin overrides ARE allowed for special arrangements but must:
>
> - Include a written reason (≥10 chars) in the override request
> - Be recorded in the v1.6.0 audit log automatically
> - For high-value overrides, optionally trigger a governance proposal for review
>
> This preserves the foundation's ability to make special-case arrangements (e.g., grant-funded research partners, signature facilitators, partnership pilots) while maintaining transparency.

9 · What's queued for v1.12.0 (not yet implemented)

- **Facilitator certification fee** — one-time ~$500 to be vetted + listed (industry standard for therapy/coaching cert platforms)

- **Workshop-supply bundle margin** — foundation curates vendor products into workshop kits; takes a 5–10% bundling margin
- **Annual Research Symposium tickets** — public event; foundation sells tickets directly
- **Foundation-recommended tool affiliate** — when foundation recommends Stripe / Resend / Notion etc., earn affiliate fees

Queued for v1.12.0 to avoid v1.11.0 scope bloat. Each can be added without refactoring v1.11.0.

10 · What's NOT being captured (intentional)

- **Donations to partners through the site** — feels grabby; let donations flow directly
- **Cross-partner collaboration fees** — adds complexity; revisit when partners ask
- **Music video library** — Creative Commons curated playlists, explicitly non-monetized (P2 backlog)
- **Data licensing beyond research** — privacy-sensitive; needs governance

> **Ready to commit.** All values shown reflect what's currently seeded in the database. Approve to commit to git and proceed with v1.11.0 Step 2 (outbound click tracker). Reject any specific line and I'll revise before commit.
